

Another Kodak moment: A lawsuit against Sony

Some years ago, Kodak settled a patent infringement lawsuit against Polaroid corporation by giving it US\$ 925 million in damages. We are pretty sure it wants that money back.



Now to make its brand name synonymous with digital photography, Kodak has filed a suit in a US Federal District Court against Sony Corp,

alleging that the latter has infringed upon 10 patents issued to Kodak within 1987 and 2003.

The patents covered various aspects of capturing, storing and displaying both, still and moving digital images. Sony's official line is: "We have not violated any Kodak patent related to digital imaging and will fully defend any allegations made in this regard."

Kodak, however, will be pretty confident of winning the case since they won a similar patent infringement case against Sanyo Corp three years ago. Sanyo then agreed to license technologies from Kodak. Before they could become another Kodak "victim", Olympus also agreed to license technologies from Kodak.

For the record, Kodak holds an amazing 1,000 digital photography patents.

Intel changes nomenclature

Intel will stop using clock speeds as the name differentiator for its processors. The new system will account for performance factors such as bus speeds and cache memory.

The Celeron line-up will get a 300 series number—for example 355—the Pentium 4 desktop processors will be the 500 series and the Pentium M mobile processors will be the 700 series.

Wait! Didn't Intel spend millions to market clock speeds as the ultimate performance gauge? Yeah, but that was to oppose AMD, who all along said that clock speed was not the only indicator of speed.

The new naming scheme seems to exchange one kind of complexity for another. The question is: Will this work better for the consumer, or will it simply make matters worse?

Apple sings— 50 million times!

In the popular folk tale The Pied Piper of Hamelyn, the storyteller never told us how many rats the piper eventually enamoured to be condemned to the sea. But we can tell you how many songs did the world's modern pied piper Apple's CEO, Steve Jobs, manage to get people download into their devices: all of 50 million, all paid for, and in only five months.

Apple's strategic tie-up with Pepsi means that another 100 million songs will be downloaded free.

It was in October that Apple expanded the iTunes store to work with Windows-based computers—just another brilliant idea from Jobs, the king of comebacks.

redalert

W32.Netsky.K@mm

If you receive an e-mail from a known person with subject "Re: Here is the document" and a .pif extension attached, your PC may already have met the Netsky virus.

The virus has its own SMTP engine and spoofs its sender's address. It searches the drives for e-mail lists in files of pre-defined extensions.

The Netsky author claims his creation actually cleans the PC of the Bagle and myDoom viruses. The author has threatened to make the source code public.

Download its removal tool from <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.netsky@mm.removal.tool.html>

DDoS by Symantec?

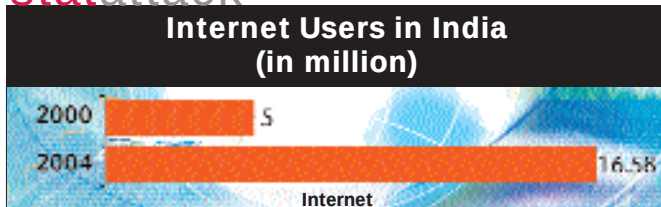
eEye, a security vendor, recently found a flaw in Norton Internet Security 2004, Norton Internet Security 2004 Professional and Norton Personal Firewall 2004, which allows an intruder to gain remote access to the victim's PC with maximum possible administrative rights and launch DoS attacks from systems running the affected software in their default installation. It found another flaw with all versions of ISS's RealSecure and BlackICE. eEye is waiting for a patch to these problems before releasing exploit details to the public.

snapshot

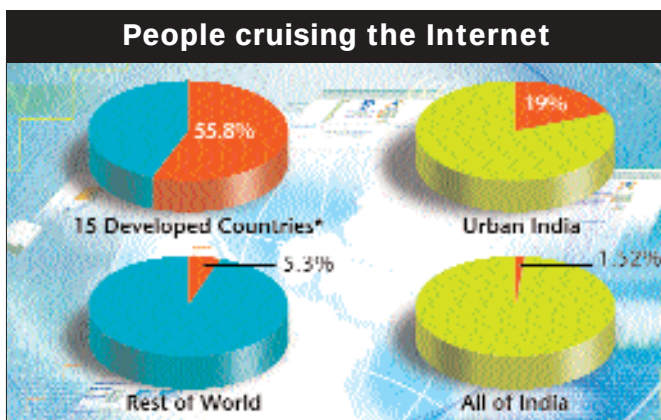
52 per cent of San Diego city in California, USA use broadband access

Source: comScore Networks

statattack



Source: Nielsen/NetRatings, ITU and Ipsos



Source: Nielsen/NetRatings and ITU